

Checklist

Endpoint Security

Keeping Endpoints Up to Date

- ☐ Enable regular operating system security updates.
- ☐ Use centralized patch management where possible.
- ☐ Verify that patches are successfully deployed.
- ☐ Keep Windows endpoints updated through Windows Update for Business or an approved management platform.
- ☐ Use MDM to manage and push updates to macOS devices.
- ☐ Configure Unix/Linux desktops to receive regular package updates.
- ☐ Automate updates with management tools or scheduled jobs where appropriate.
- ☐ Establish a process for updating unmanaged/BYOD devices.
- ☐ Keep third-party applications patched and current.
- ☐ Monitor software without automatic updates for new releases.
- ☐ Maintain an inventory of installed applications and versions.

Harden Endpoints

- ☐ Establish a secure baseline configuration for each endpoint type.
- ☐ Remove or disable unnecessary services.
- ☐ Confirm what a service does before disabling it.
- ☐ Regularly review running services and processes.
- ☐ Remove unnecessary applications and components.
- ☐ Limit unnecessary functionality to reduce the attack surface.

Use Desktop Firewalls

- ☐ Enable the host-based firewall on every endpoint.
- ☐ Configure inbound traffic restrictions.
- ☐ Restrict outbound traffic where appropriate.
- ☐ Review firewall rules periodically.

- ☐ Apply firewall policies to devices used on home, public, or otherwise untrusted networks.

Implement Full-Disk Encryption

- ☐ Enable full-disk encryption on laptops and desktops containing organizational data.
- ☐ Use BitLocker on supported Windows systems.
- ☐ Use FileVault on supported macOS systems.
- ☐ Use an appropriate full-disk encryption solution on Linux/Unix systems.
- ☐ Store or centrally manage recovery keys where required.
- ☐ Confirm encryption is active before deploying devices.
- ☐ Remember that a locked, sleeping, or hibernating device may still retain encryption keys in memory.
- ☐ Shut down devices when stronger protection against physical attacks is required.

Endpoint Protection

- ☐ Install approved antivirus/antimalware or endpoint protection software.
- ☐ Keep endpoint protection software and signatures updated.
- ☐ Confirm protection services are running correctly.
- ☐ Regularly review alerts and detections.
- ☐ Do not rely on endpoint protection as the only security control.

Mobile Device Management

- ☐ Enroll supported mobile devices in an MDM platform.
- ☐ Enforce PIN/password requirements.
- ☐ Enforce VPN use where required.
- ☐ Control or restrict application installation.
- ☐ Apply approved configuration policies.
- ☐ Enable remote erase/wipe capabilities.
- ☐ Define which device types and platforms the organization will support.
- ☐ Apply appropriate controls to BYOD devices.

Endpoint Visibility and Monitoring

- ☐ Collect endpoint security telemetry.
- ☐ Monitor open network connections.
- ☐ Monitor running processes.
- ☐ Monitor open files and other relevant system activity.
- ☐ Centralize endpoint logs where possible.
- ☐ Use endpoint data to support malware detection and incident investigation.
- ☐ Consider tools such as osquery or Sysmon where appropriate.
- ☐ Define employee privacy expectations before deploying extensive monitoring.
- ☐ Coordinate monitoring policies with HR/legal requirements.

Secure Other Endpoints

- ☐ Inventory nontraditional endpoints and IoT devices.
- ☐ Change default passwords immediately.
- ☐ Remove or disable unnecessary default accounts.
- ☐ Keep device firmware and software updated.
- ☐ Segment insecure or specialized devices from sensitive systems where appropriate.
- ☐ Include printers in endpoint security reviews.
- ☐ Include IP-enabled cameras.
- ☐ Include IP-enabled thermostats/HVAC systems.
- ☐ Include electronic door-locking systems.
- ☐ Include IP telephony systems.
- ☐ Include SCADA/industrial-control devices where applicable.
- ☐ Document, secure, and test specialized devices before placing them into production.

Centralize Endpoint Management

- ☐ Use centralized management consoles wherever practical.
- ☐ Centralize authentication.
- ☐ Centralize configuration and policy enforcement.
- ☐ Centralize patch and software management.
- ☐ Centralize security logging.
- ☐ Centralize organizational file storage where appropriate.
- ☐ Maintain consistent configurations across similar endpoint types.
- ☐ Reduce unnecessary administrative overhead through automation.

Final Endpoint Security Review

- ☐ All operating systems are patched.
- ☐ Third-party applications are patched.
- ☐ Unnecessary services are disabled.
- ☐ Host firewalls are enabled.
- ☐ Full-disk encryption is enabled.
- ☐ Endpoint protection is installed and current.
- ☐ Mobile devices are appropriately managed.
- ☐ Endpoint activity is sufficiently logged and monitored.
- ☐ IoT and specialized endpoints are inventoried and secured.
- ☐ Endpoint security controls are centrally managed where practical.